

# Foreword

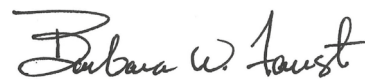
**Each year Smithsonian Gardens welcome over 30 million visitors to our lush gardens along the National Mall in Washington, D.C. These “living museums” have been created to complement the collections of the world’s largest complex of museums, the Smithsonian Institution.**

The talented staff of Smithsonian Gardens face challenges similar to those of any gardener. Overcoming these challenges to create a healthy and beautiful garden is part of what makes gardening so enjoyable and rewarding. With the release of *Encyclopedia of Garden Plants for Every Location*, Smithsonian Gardens is proud to extend our educational mission beyond our physical location, sharing our knowledge and passion for creating successful outdoor spaces.

It is our hope that this book will inspire you at home. As a comprehensive guide for gardeners of all levels, this book contains helpful information for planting in a wide array of garden conditions. Choosing the proper plant to suit your growing conditions will lead to a thriving and sustainable garden.

Every garden differs and part of their appeal is in the exploration. With such diverse conditions throughout North America, it is helpful to consult with your local extension office or trusted neighborhood garden center to make the best plant choices.

I speak for all my colleagues when I say that the publication of this volume is a proud moment in the history of Smithsonian Gardens. I would like to thank everyone who worked so thoroughly on this project, especially recognizing two members of the Smithsonian Gardens staff: horticulturist James Gagliardi, and collections and education manager Cynthia Brown. It is our hope that *Encyclopedia of Garden Plants for Every Location* becomes your new favorite garden plant reference book and motivates you to visit us someday at Smithsonian Gardens.



Barbara W. Faust  
Director, Smithsonian Gardens

